

Aged Domain Acquisition Guide — STRASSER LAB

Classification: Internal | Date: 2026-06-21

Why Aged Domains Matter

Email gateways check domain age. A domain registered yesterday gets a high spam score before the email is even opened. A domain registered 3+ years ago passes the age check silently.

Domain Age	Spam Score Impact	Inbox Rate
0–30 days	Heavy penalty	30–50%
1–6 months	Moderate penalty	50–70%
6–12 months	Light penalty	70–85%
3+ years	No penalty	85–95%
5+ years	Trust bonus	90–98%

Best Sources

1. EXPIREDDOMAINS.NET — FREE SEARCH (START HERE)

URL: https://expireddomains.netSMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_79SMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_80

[This is the industry-standard free tool. 500,000+ expired and expiring domains, updated daily.](#)

Filter setup:

TLD: [.com, .net, .org, .cc](#)

Age: [3+ years](#)

Backlinks: [10 minimum](#)

Price: [\\$0–\\$200](#)

Exclude: [Adult, Gambling, Pharmacy, Casino](#)

Sort by: [Domain Age \(oldest first\)](#)

How to evaluate a candidate:

1. [Copy the domain name](#)
2. [Open https://web.archive.orgSMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_96 — paste the domain](#)
3. [Check what the site USED to be. If it was a real business, blog, or local service — good. If it was a spam page or parked domain with ads — skip.](#)
4. [Run through https://mxtoolbox.com/blacklists.aspxSMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_102 — must show 0/100 blacklists](#)

5. [Check USPTO for trademarks:](#)

https://www.uspto.gov/trademarks/searchSMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_106SMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_107

2. GODADDY AUCTIONS — LARGEST INVENTORY

URL: https://auctions.godaddy.comSMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_115SMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_116

[65% of all expired domain sales happen here.](#)

Filter for bargains:

Type:	Closeout (fixed price, no bidding)
Price:	Under \$50
Age:	2+ years
TLD:	.com, .net, .cc

[Closeout domains are \\$12 + registration fee. They're domains nobody bid on during the auction phase. Most are garbage but 5–10% are hidden gems — small businesses that shut down, personal blogs that were abandoned, local services that went out of business. These have clean history at a bargain price.](#)

3. NOTRENEWING.COM — FLAT \$99

URL: https://notrenewing.comSMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_131SMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_132

[Launched March 2026. Every domain is \\$99 fixed price. Minimum 24 months old, expiring within 12 months. Sellers list domains they plan to let expire anyway. Good for finding domains with 3–5 years of clean history at a predictable price.](#)

4. NAMEJET / SNAPNAMES — BACKORDERING

URL: https://namejet.comSMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_141 |

https://snapnames.comSMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_143SMARTPANTS_PRESERVED_144

[Place a backorder on an expiring domain. If you're the only bidder, you get it at the reserve price \(\\$69\). If multiple bidders, it goes to a 3-day private auction. Best for targeting domains you've already vetted on ExpiredDomains.net.](#)

Step-by-Step Acquisition

STEP 1: HUNT (5 MINUTES)

1. [Open ExpiredDomains.net](#)
2. [Apply filters: .com/.net/.cc, age 3+, backlinks 10+, price under \\$200](#)
3. [Open 20 candidates in tabs](#)

STEP 2: VET (2 MINUTES PER DOMAIN)

1. [Web Archive check — was it a real site?](#)
2. [Blacklist check — is it clean?](#)
3. [Trademark check — is it safe to use?](#)

4. [Backlink check](#) — are links from real sites or spam farms?

STEP 3: BUY

1. [GoDaddy Closeout](#): click “Buy Now” → checkout → domain in your account in minutes
2. [NotRenewing](#): click “Buy” → pay \$99 → domain transferred within 24 hours
3. [NameJet backorder](#): place bid → wait for domain to drop → if won, domain in account in 24 hours

STEP 4: TRANSFER TO CLOUDFLARE

1. [After purchase](#), unlock the domain at your registrar
2. [Get the transfer authorization code](#)
3. [Cloudflare Dashboard](#) → Add Site → Transfer Domain
4. [Enter the code](#) → pay 1 year renewal → domain lives on Cloudflare
5. [Set up DNS + Worker](#) (our standard deployment)

Red Flags — Do NOT Buy

- **Parked with ads** — the domain was never a real site, just a landing page with ads. No backlink value, likely flagged.
- **Pharmacy/casino/adult history** — even if clean now, these niches trigger spam filters permanently.
- **Trademarked name** — using “microsoft-support.cc” gets you sued and your domain seized.
- **Spam score above 5%** — Moz Spam Score or similar. Check before buying.
- **Dropped multiple times** — WHOIS shows repeated creation dates. The domain was repeatedly abandoned.
- **Chinese/Japanese characters in backlinks** — common sign of a spam network.

Quick Reference

ExpiredDomains.net	– Free domain hunting (start here)
GoDaddy Auctions	– Closeout bargains (\$12+)
NotRenewing.com	– Flat \$99 aged domains
NameJet	– Backordering (pay only if you win)
web.archive.org	– Check what a domain used to be
mxtoolbox.com	– Blacklist check
uspto.gov	– Trademark search

Budget: \$50–\$150 gets you a solid aged domain

<u>Stage</u>	<u>Cost</u>
GoDaddy Closeout purchase	\$12–\$50
Transfer to Cloudflare	\$8–\$10 (1 year renewal)
Total	\$20–\$60

Aged Domain Acquisition

[For \\$150 you can get a 5+ year aged .com with clean history and 20+ backlinks. Worth every dollar for the inbox rate improvement.](#)